



City of Doral

ITN - 2025-20

AI-Powered Chatbot Solution for the City of Doral

Addendum No. 5

September 17, 2025

The original Invitation to Negotiate (ITN) 2025-20 documents shall remain in full force and effect, except as modified herein, which shall take precedence over any contrary provisions in the prior documents.

I. The following are answers to questions from prospective proposers of ITN-2025-20.

1. Q. Our AI system may rely on third-party orchestration tools to enable automation. Is the use of such external platforms acceptable within your security policies, and what safeguards or compliance certifications would they need to demonstrate?

A. **Yes, the use of third-party orchestration tools may be acceptable, provided that they comply with our security and regulatory requirements. Any external platform leveraged to enable automation must:**
 - **Meet Government Security Standards**
 - Provide SOC 2 Type II or equivalent independent audit reports demonstrating operational security and trust controls.
 - **Provide Industry-Recognized Certification**
 - Maintain certifications such as ISO/IEC 27001 (Information Security Management), ISO/IEC 27017 (Cloud Security), and/or ISO/IEC 27701 (Privacy), CJIS compliance or any other industry compliance certification.
 - **Demonstrate Operational Security**
 - Show evidence of secure development lifecycle (SDLC) practices, vulnerability management, and penetration testing.
 - Maintain an incident response plan with defined notification timelines.
 - Require background checks and security training for all staff with administrative access.

2. Q. The bid highlights usability for staff; can you outline the number and categories of staff who will use the system, and whether expectations vary between frontline employees and administrators? To better gauge the system's complexity, what level of training or onboarding will staff be given?

A. **At implementation, the City anticipates 2-3 SME's from each department should be trained by vendor for operational use, including a Director or Assistant Director. Then, it would likely be front line staff that interact with the system daily. Any configuration training should be conducted with IT Department and Development Services System Analyst.**

3. Q. The ITN emphasizes compliance with privacy and security laws but does not specify whether the chatbot must be hosted on-premises, in a US-based cloud or a global cloud. This information would be vital in developing the chatbot so that we can set up credentials and accesses accordingly, so can you clarify the City's data residency and hosting requirements?

A. The City of opening to allowing either on premise or US based cloud for all City's data residency and hosting requirements.

4. Q. The document states that the City does not currently have a CRM system but is open to either integrating with a third-party CRM or adopting an integrated CRM from the vendor. Can you clarify how and when the City will decide which CRM approach it prefers, and whether vendors should propose both options or focus on one?

A. Currently, the City is in the early stages of evaluating Customer Relationship Management (CRM) solutions. The City's priority is to implement the AI Chatbot solution first, and once it is successfully deployed, we will begin ramping up discussions around CRM adoption.

5. Q. Which social media platforms will we be using and who will set up the account credentials?

A. Integration with our social media is not required or something we are looking.

6. Q. The ITN mentions a total of four evaluation phases, with Phase 2 being closed to the public and involving sealed pricing. Can the City confirm if the price submitted in Phase 2 is the final binding price or if it's subject to negotiation in Phase 3?

A. During Phase I, proposals will be evaluated without consideration of pricing. The following criteria will be reviewed during Phase I:

- **Experience and Qualifications**
- **Technical Solution**
- **Implementation Plan**
- **Solution Capabilities**
- **Security and Compliance**
- **Performance Evaluation Surveys**

The Evaluation committee may use the results of Phase I to shortlist proposers.

During Phase II, price and value will be incorporated into the Evaluation Process and ranked. Once again, the Evaluation committee may use the results of Phase II to shortlist proposers.

During Phase III; negotiations, there will be scheduled meetings with each finalist. Once these meetings are concluded, an opportunity will be provided

to the finalists to submit a “Best and Final Offer” (BAFO). The BAFO provides the finalists with an opportunity to amend their price and value based on the results of the negotiation meetings.

Phae IV will provide the evaluation committee with the ability to review and rank the BAFOs submitted by the finalists among other criterias.

7. Q. The ITN indicates a preference for a three-year initial agreement with two one-year renewal options. Are there any circumstances under which the city would consider a different contract structure, such as a five-year initial term?
- A. **There will be an opportunity to discuss other contractual structures as a result of the Phase III; negotiations.**
8. Q. Why is the City undertaking this chatbot initiative now? Are there broader strategic objectives that this project is intended to serve?
- A. **The city likes having the ability to answer customer inquiries any time of day and previously had an integrated chatbot; understanding that the technology has changed over the last several years, we are hoping for a more robust solution, that scrapes data daily and can respond in real-time without live agents; maintaining our hands on touches with our customers and steering them to the right answer every time.**
9. Q. Please clarify the City’s preferred approach to ongoing system management. Does the City plan to leverage internal IT resources for day-to-day administration, with vendor support available for escalations, or is the City seeking to outsource the system management function to the vendor fully?
- A. **IT Support expected with vendor support for escalations.**
10. Q. The ITN specifies that the chatbot must be able to "scrape the City's website daily". What is the total number of pages on the City's website and associated departmental sites that the chatbot would need to scrape?
- A. **Response to this question will be provided during the negotiation Phase of this ITN procurement process.**
11. Q. The ITN mentions an average of 350,000 visitors per month to the City's website. Can the City provide historical data on website traffic, such as peak usage times (e.g., specific days of the week or times of day), to help us better understand the potential load on the chatbot?
- A. **Response to this question will be discussed during the negotiation Phase of this ITN procurement process.**
12. Q. The ITN mentions the possibility of an IVR integration, stating the goal is for the chatbot to function as a "solution center" and alert agents when a customer needs help. Since the City does not currently have an IVR system or a dedicated call center, can the City clarify the specific "agents" and departments that would be responsible for receiving these alerts?

- A. Previously answered with training question; expect 1-2 departmental frontline SMEs that would receive incoming queries.**
13. Q. The ITN identifies Tyler Permitting System, Tyler 311, and the Parks and Recreation system as key systems for integration. Can the City provide documentation or technical details on the available APIs for these systems?
- A. Our Parks and Recreation is in the process of transitioning to a new platform listed below.**
- <https://content.civicplus.com/api/docs>
- <https://tylertech.accessgov.com/docs/Forms/Page/docs/api/0>
14. Q. The ITN requires the chatbot to provide data that can be integrated with Microsoft Power BI dashboards. Can the City specify the preferred method for data transfer (e.g., direct API access, a data warehouse, flat files) and the format of the data (e.g., JSON, CSV, XML)?
- A. The City's preferred method for data transfer is through direct API access, with the data provided in JSON format to ensure seamless integration with Microsoft Power BI dashboards. As a secondary option, the City would accept flat file transfers in CSV or XML format**
15. Q. The ITN lists desired data to be captured in a CRM, such as full name, email, mobile phone, and user role. Can the City confirm if the chatbot should also capture interaction-specific details, such as the type of service requested or the outcome of the interaction?
- A. This would be ideal to improve service going forward.**
16. Q. In Addendum No. 2, question 6, the City provided several examples of FAQs, such as permitting intake and inspection scheduling. Is the City able to provide a more comprehensive or prioritized list of these requests, perhaps by department?
- A. Yes, the City can provide a more comprehensive and prioritized list of FAQs by department. This list will be finalized in coordination with the respective departments to ensure accuracy and alignment with their service needs. Examples of likely priority areas include:**
- **Planning & Zoning:** Zoning code clarifications, land use inquiries, and application requirements.
 - **Public Works:** Service requests which then routes users to the Tyler 311.
 - **Parks & Recreation:** Program registration, facility rental procedures, and event schedules
 - **Finance/Procurement:** Payment options, due date reminders, and account creations/assistance.
 - **Building Department:** Permitting intake, inspection scheduling, plan review status, and fee inquiries.
 - **Code Enforcement:** Reporting property maintenance violations, code compliance timelines, citation inquiries, and appeals process.

The City will be more specific with the finalists during the negotiation Phase of the ITN procurement process.

17. Q. The ITN requires an implementation plan that ensures "minimal disruption to City operations". Can the City provide details on the typical business hours and any known high-volume periods for the departments that will be using the chatbot?

A. City Hall is open 7am-5pm with individual department hours varying. Peak volume times typically found in Licensing during renewal season (currently underway). No other known peak volumes to be concerned with.

18. Q. Can you clarify who holds ownership and management responsibility for the city website, and whether there are any frequency or volume limitations (e.g., rate limits, bandwidth restrictions, or access policies) that we should be aware of when designing automated data scraping or extraction processes?

A. The Public affairs Department holds ownership of the website. No frequency or volume limits

19. Q. Could you provide the total number of citizen inquiries received, along with a breakdown by month and by week?

A. We currently have no centralize system to provide this data?

20. Q. How many website visitors or footprint do you have on the website per month or per week?

A. Unable to decipher or provide such information at this time.

21. Q. How are citizen inquiries currently received (e.g., phone, email, online forms, walk-ins)?

A. Citizens inquiries are received by many channels, phone, walk-ins, online forms.

22. Q. How many human agents currently manage these inquiries?

A. Two who are located in our Solution Center(in-person)

23. Q. How much time does it take to respond to a particular citizen inquiry or for resolution? (Turn around time)

A. It depends on the complexity of the inquiry and the inquiry is within our Jurisdiction.

24. Q. Are inquiries handled by live agents within the City, or through an external call center?

A. We do not have any live agents or external call center.

25. Q. If an IVR system is in place, which platform/vendor is currently being used?
- A. None in place.**
26. Q. Do you use any call center or Live Agent software? Please specify the software or product that you use.
- A. None at this time.**
27. Q. Would you like the awarded vendor to implement the entire scope that is mentioned in the scope of services in the RFP, or would you prefer a phased approach where specific components are introduced gradually?
- A. Either options works for the City so long as the Vendor remains consistent with implementations.**
28. Q. What are the top most common questions you get from citizens? Do you get a lot of level 1 types of question? Or more complex questions like doing building inspection, license permit, property tax payment, raise a complaint etc? (This will help us decide logically on the scope of work to start with)
- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**
29. Q. Could you provide more detail on the workflow for business transactions? (The customizable workflows use-cases) What all use-cases would like to include? Do you need this in phase-1 or in the future phases?
- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum**
30. Q. Specifically, how does data from inquiries currently flow between systems, and what platforms are involved?
- A. There is no data flow, communications are via email or phone call internally.**
31. Q. How frequently is the City's website content updated (e.g., daily, weekly, bi-monthly), and should the chatbot's data refresh schedule align with this update frequency?
- A. Daily.**
32. Q. Can you please share which cloud/technology platform the City of Doral is currently using (e.g., IBM, Microsoft Azure, or AWS)
- A. The City current Using all three with other third party vendors.**
33. Q. Is there a preferred or prohibited list of subcontractors or vendors?
- A. If you are referring to debarred vendors by the city, no, none at this time.**

34. Q. Are there any restrictions on where the work must be performed (e.g., within the issuing state, within the U.S., or onshore vs. offshore)?
- A. **Work may be performed as outlined in your question, the only requirement requested by the city if the proposer have an office location within the United States.**
35. Q. Are there any data residency or data sovereignty requirements that would restrict where data can be accessed or stored?
- A. **Yes, the City prefers for data to reside within the United States. Whether on the cloud or on-premise.**
36. Q. Does any portion of the work (e.g., hosting, support, development) need to be performed on-site or within government facilities?
- A. **No.**
37. Q. Are there any specific legal, regulatory, or compliance reasons that would prevent the use of out-of-state or offshore resources (e.g., HIPAA, CJIS, FedRAMP, state IT policies)?
- A. **The City must comply with federal, state, and local requirements regarding data security, privacy, and sovereignty. Specifically, CJIS (Criminal Justice Information Services) and other state-level statutes restrict where and how sensitive data can be stored or accessed. These requirements effectively prevent the use of offshore resources for systems that process, store, or transmit City data.**
38. Q. If off-site or remote delivery is permitted, are there additional security controls required (e.g., VPN, dedicated machines, endpoint monitoring)?
- A. **Yes. If off-site or remote delivery is permitted, the City requires additional security controls to ensure compliance and protect sensitive information. These include, but are not limited to:**
- **Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA): Required for all remote access.**
 - **Encrypted Connections: Use of VPNs or secure tunnels (TLS 1.2 or higher).**
 - **Endpoint Security: All devices must have up-to-date antivirus, endpoint detection/response (EDR), and patch management.**
 - **Access Controls: Role-based access with least privilege, including regular reviews.**
 - **Audit & Logging: Full monitoring of remote sessions with logs retained per City policy.**
 - **Data Handling: No storage of City data on personal devices; all data must remain within approved systems.**

39. Q. Is the client open to cloud-based solutions for this project?
- A. **Yes.**
40. Q. Are there any restrictions on cloud hosting (e.g., must be hosted in a specific region/state/country)?
- A. **Yes, in the United State only.**
41. Q. Does the agency/client have a preferred cloud provider (e.g., AWS, Azure, Google Cloud)?
- A. **Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum**
42. Q. Is there an existing cloud strategy or mandate that this work must align with (e.g., cloud-first policy, state contract with a cloud vendor)?
- A. **No.**
43. Q. Are hybrid or multi-cloud architectures acceptable?
- A. **Yes.**
44. Q. Does the client require FedRAMP, StateRAMP, or other cloud compliance certifications?
- A. **Yes.**
45. Q. Are there existing on-premise systems or legacy infrastructure that must be integrated with a cloud solution?
- A. **Yes.**
46. Q. If the solution must be hosted on government infrastructure, is a move to the cloud anticipated in a future phase?
- A. **The solution isn't required to be hosted on Government infrastructure.**
47. Q. Who is responsible for cloud infrastructure provisioning—vendor or client?
- A. **Vendor.**
48. Q. Are there any data residency, security, or audit requirements that would affect how and where the cloud solution is hosted?
- A. **Yes, United States only. The City will allow any platform.**
49. Q. Is there a preferred delivery methodology for this engagement (e.g., Agile, Waterfall, Hybrid)?
- A. **No preferred method.**

50. Q. Is the agency open to Agile or iterative approaches, particularly for discovery, prototyping, or phased delivery?

A. Yes we are.

51. Q. If Agile is acceptable, are there internal stakeholders (e.g., Product Owners, Scrum Masters) who can participate in ceremonies (standups, sprint reviews, etc.)?

A. Yes.

52. Q. Are there existing constraints that require a Waterfall approach (e.g., funding models, regulatory gates, legacy SDLC)?

A. No

53. Q. Is a hybrid approach (e.g., Agile within defined stage gates) acceptable or encouraged?

A. Open to all Project management styles, none is preferred over the other.

54. Q. Are there mandated documentation or milestone approvals that must be preserved within any chosen delivery model?

A. Yes. The City requires that mandated documentation and milestone approvals be preserved regardless of the delivery model. At a minimum, this includes:

- **Project Charter and Scope Documents — signed by stakeholders.**
- **Requirements Documentation — functional, technical, and security requirements.**
- **Design & Architecture Reviews — approval checkpoints prior to build/development.**
- **Testing & Validation Evidence — including UAT sign-off.**
- **Change Management Approvals — per City policy.**
- **Go-Live / Deployment Authorizations — formal approvals prior to production release.**
- **Post-Implementation Reviews — lessons learned and performance validation.**

55. Q. Will vendors have flexibility to propose the methodology they believe best suits the project's complexity and risk profile?

A. Yes.

56. Q. Are there existing tools or platforms the agency uses to support Agile delivery (e.g., Jira, Azure DevOps, Confluence)?

A. Monday.com

57. Q. How will optional features (SMS, IVR, document parsing) be evaluated—are they “nice-to-have” or expected for award?

A. Nice to have, priority is the Chatbot.

58. Q. Is there a target date for chatbot launch (e.g., by end of FY2026), or should vendors propose their own schedule?

A. The City has not set a fixed target date for the chatbot launch at this time. Vendors are encouraged to propose a realistic and phased implementation schedule as part of their submissions, based on best practices and their recommended approach.

That said, the City’s goal is to have meaningful progress and a functional initial rollout aligned with strategic priorities within the FY2025–FY2026 timeframe.

59. Q. Does the City have an existing list of FAQs, service requests, or citizen interaction logs that the chatbot should be trained on?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum

60. Q. Will the City provide a baseline set of citizen questions (e.g., billing, permits, public safety)?

A. No.

61. Q. Which City departments should the chatbot initially cover (e.g., City Hall services, Police, Public Works, Parks & Recreation)?

A. This question will be discussed further with the finalists during the negotiation phase 3 of this ITN procurement process.

62. Q. Will the chatbot expand to additional departments over time?

A. Yes.

63. Q. Beyond English and Spanish, are there other languages (e.g., Haitian Creole) that the City anticipates supporting in the future?

A. As many languages as the Vendor can support.

64. Q. Are there specific accessibility requirements (screen reader compatibility, voice support) that go beyond WCAG 2.1?

A. i. The City requires all solutions to be fully compliant with WCAG 2.1 AA standards at a minimum. Beyond this, the City encourages vendors to incorporate additional accessibility features to ensure inclusivity for all residents. Examples include:

- Screen Reader Compatibility: Full support for NVDA, JAWS, and VoiceOver.**

- **Voice Support:** Voice input and response capabilities for users with mobility or vision impairments.
- **Multilingual Accessibility:** Options for translation and captioning to support non-English speakers and hearing-impaired users.
- **Keyboard Navigation:** Ensuring all functions are accessible without a mouse.
- **Contrast & Readability Enhancements:** To assist users with low vision or color blindness.

65. Q. Will the City provide structured FAQ content, or should the chatbot scrape all content from the website and infer intent?

A. Scrape all content, along with City's content.

66. Q. Should vendors recommend restructuring the City's website to improve chatbot accuracy?

A. Yes, vendors may recommend restructuring or optimizing portions of the City's website if it will improve chatbot accuracy, navigation, and user experience. The City recognizes that a well-structured website with clear content hierarchy and metadata can significantly enhance chatbot performance and integration with knowledge sources.

However, any such recommendations should be presented as optional value-added enhancements, with clear justification of how they improve chatbot accuracy, accessibility, and long-term maintainability.

67. Q. Should the chatbot only answer informational questions, or should it also guide users through transactions (e.g., paying bills, scheduling appointments)?

A. Both.

68. Q. Which workflows are in scope for automation in the first phase?

A. This question will be discussed further with the finalists during the negotiation phase 3 of this ITN procurement process.

69. Q. How should the chatbot handle questions it cannot answer? Should it escalate to a live agent or submit a help ticket?

A. Both options are viable.

70. Q. Does the City expect vendors to curate and expand the chatbot's question library over time, or will City staff manage content?

A. The City expects chatbot content and the question library to be a collaborative effort. Initially, vendors should assist in curating, structuring, and expanding the question library to ensure a strong foundation and accurate coverage of high-priority use cases.

Over time, City staff will take on the primary role of managing and updating content, with vendor support available for training, advanced configuration, and periodic optimization as needed. The goal is to ensure the chatbot remains current, accurate, and scalable as resident needs evolve

71. Q. Regarding Customizable Workflows and Integration with Other Systems, the solution should include customizable workflows for tasks like scheduling appointments and service requests. The "Qualifications / Experience of Proposer" also mentions "Integration Expertise" with "permitting software". Beyond general FAQs and appointments, can the City provide specific examples of common processes or service requests that are high priority for automation via these customizable workflows? Also, if integration with "permitting software" is expected, can the City identify the current permitting system (vendor/platform) in use?

A. **Answer to the first part of the question has been provided in previous issued Addendum**

The City currently uses Tyler Technologies' permitting platform as its core system of record. Vendors should demonstrate integration expertise with Tyler systems (or similar permitting platforms) to ensure seamless data exchange, status updates, and workflow automation."

72. Q. Regarding the Content Management Interface (CMS Functionality), the ITN states the solution must include an "easy-to-use interface for City staff to update content, workflows, and FAQs without requiring technical expertise". Could the City elaborate on specific functionalities or features expected within this Content Management Interface? For instance, are there requirements for content versioning, multi-user editing, content approval workflows, or a particular type of content editor (e.g., WYSIWYG)? Additionally, is the City looking for this interface to be an integral module within the proposed chatbot platform, or is it open to a separate, integrated Content Management System (CMS) that interacts with the chatbot solution?

A. **The City expects the Content Management Interface (CMS) to provide non-technical staff with the ability to easily manage chatbot content, FAQs, and workflows. At a minimum, the following functionalities are expected:**

- **Content Versioning: Ability to track revisions and restore previous versions when needed.**
- **Multi-User Access & Roles: Support for multiple editors, with role-based permissions (e.g., author, reviewer, administrator).**
- **Content Approval Workflows: Optional workflows for review/approval prior to publishing updates.**
- **Search & Organization Tools: Categorization, tagging, and keyword management for efficient content organization.**
- **Audit Logging: Track who made changes and when, ensuring accountability and transparency.**

Regarding deployment approach: The City's preference is for the CMS functionality to be delivered as an integrated module within the chatbot platform, ensuring seamless updates and minimizing administrative burden. However, the City is also open to evaluating solutions that leverage a separate but integrated CMS, provided the integration is secure, reliable, and does not add significant complexity for end users."

73. Q. Regarding Integration with IVR and Social Channels, the chatbot should integrate with IVR systems for continuity and with social media channels (Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp). Does the City currently operate an IVR system? If so, what is its current vendor/platform? What is the expected level of integration with IVR (e.g., merely transferring context, or full voice bot capabilities, handoff to live agents)? For social media, are there specific use cases or priority channels among Instagram, Facebook, and WhatsApp?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

74. Q. How should the chatbot handle questions it cannot answer? Should it escalate to a live agent or submit a help ticket?

A. Both options would suffice.

75. Q. Does the City expect vendors to curate and expand the chatbot's question library over time, or will City staff manage content?

A. The City anticipates a collaborative approach to managing the chatbot's question library. Vendors are expected to assist with the initial curation, structuring, and expansion of the knowledge base to ensure comprehensive coverage of high-priority use cases and accuracy at launch.

Over time, primary responsibility for maintaining and expanding the question library will transition to City staff. Vendors should provide training, documentation, and knowledge transfer to enable City staff to manage content effectively. Vendors may also be engaged periodically for advanced optimization, updates, or expansion support as needed.

76. Q. Regarding Customizable Workflows and Integration with Other Systems, the solution should include customizable workflows for tasks like scheduling appointments and service requests. The "Qualifications / Experience of Proposer" also mentions "Integration Expertise" with "permitting software". Beyond general FAQs and appointments, can the City provide specific examples of common processes or service requests that are high priority for automation via these customizable workflows? Also, if integration with "permitting software" is expected, can the City identify the current permitting system (vendor/platform) in use?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

77. Q. Regarding the Content Management Interface (CMS Functionality), the ITN states the solution must include an "easy-to-use interface for City staff to update content, workflows, and FAQs without requiring technical expertise". Could the City elaborate on specific functionalities or features expected within this Content

Management Interface? For instance, are there requirements for content versioning, multi-user editing, content approval workflows, or a particular type of content editor (e.g., WYSIWYG)? Additionally, is the City looking for this interface to be an integral module within the proposed chatbot platform, or is it open to a separate, integrated Content Management System (CMS) that interacts with the chatbot solution?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

78. Q. Regarding Integration with IVR and Social Channels, the chatbot should integrate with IVR systems for continuity and with social media channels (Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp). Does the City currently operate an IVR system? If so, what is its current vendor/platform? What is the expected level of integration with IVR (e.g., merely transferring context, or full voice bot capabilities, handoff to live agents)? For social media, are there specific use cases or priority channels among Instagram, Facebook, and WhatsApp?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

79. Q. Regarding Announcements & Alerts and Notification Channels, the ITN specifies that the system should allow for "timely announcements, such as system upgrades, office closures, or important city events, to be pushed to users". What are the primary channels through which the City intends to "push" these announcements and alerts to users (e.g., directly within the chatbot interface, as pop-ups on the City website, via email, or other methods)? Are there any requirements for audience segmentation (e.g., by topic, geographic area, or user preference) when sending these announcements?

A. The City envisions multiple channels for distributing announcements and alerts to ensure residents receive timely and relevant information. At a minimum, the following channels are expected:

- **Within the Chatbot Interface:** Real-time notifications and banners for users actively engaging with the chatbot.
- **City Website Pop-Ups or Banner Alerts:** Visible notifications for high-priority updates such as closures or emergencies.
- **Email Notifications:** For residents who have opted in to receive updates via subscription lists.
- **Optional Integration with SMS/Text Messaging or Mobile Apps:** To provide additional reach for urgent alerts.

Regarding audience segmentation:

Yes, the City anticipates a need for targeting based on topic, geographic area, or user preferences. For example:

- **Service-specific updates (e.g., permitting system downtime).**
- **Location-based alerts (e.g., road closures in a specific district).**
- **User-defined preferences (e.g., Parks & Recreation event notifications).**

80. Q. Regarding Scope of Content Scraping and Document Parsing, the chatbot needs to scrape the City's website daily and "read and interpret embedded documents such as PDFs, DOCX files, and SharePoint files." Could the City provide a more detailed estimate of the volume and complexity of content (e.g., number of web pages, average number/size of PDFs/DOCX, number of SharePoint sites/files) that the chatbot is expected to parse and maintain? Are there any specific security protocols or access requirements for accessing non-public SharePoint files, if applicable?

A. The City anticipates that the chatbot will need to parse and maintain a moderate but diverse content set. Current estimates include:

- **City Website: Approximately 2600 active web pages across multiple departments.**
- **Documents: Several hundred embedded files (PDFs and DOCX), averaging 2600 pages each, with some larger reports exceeding 50 pages.**

81. Q. Regarding Text/SMS Notification Use Cases and Consent Management (if enabled), if the City chooses to enable Text/SMS capabilities, the chatbot should support sending "notifications, reminders, or updates via text message". Could the City provide specific examples of the types and anticipated frequency of notifications, reminders, or updates it envisions sending to citizens via SMS? Furthermore, beyond general recordkeeping, what specific mechanisms or requirements does the City have for obtaining and managing user consent for these SMS communications to ensure compliance with privacy regulations?

A. If Text/SMS capabilities are enabled, the City anticipates using this channel for time-sensitive and high-value notifications. Examples include:

- **Reminders: Permit or license renewal deadlines, upcoming inspections, scheduled appointments.**
- **Notifications: Utility billing due dates, service disruptions, emergency alerts.**
- **Updates: Event reminders, road closures, office closures, and program registration confirmations.**

Anticipated frequency: Most residents would receive 1–3 messages per month, though certain high-touch services (e.g., permitting or inspections) could involve more frequent communications during active processes.

Consent management requirements:

To ensure compliance with privacy and communications regulations the City requires that vendors provide mechanisms for:

- **Opt-In/Opt-Out Management: Clear user consent at the time of enrollment, with ability to opt out at any time.**

- **Consent Logging:** Secure recordkeeping of when and how consent was granted.
- **Preference Management:** Allowing users to customize the type or category of notifications they wish to receive.
- **Privacy Safeguards:** Ensuring no personal data is shared or used outside of the consented communication purpose.

The City expects vendors to demonstrate compliance with all relevant federal and state regulations governing SMS communication and to provide documentation of how consent is obtained, stored, and managed.

82. Q. Does the City prefer vendors to propose a specific LLM, or will the City select/approve the model during implementation?

A. The City does not require vendors to propose a specific Large Language Model (LLM). Vendors are encouraged to recommend models they believe best meet the City's requirements for security, accuracy, scalability, and cost-effectiveness.

Final selection or approval of the LLM will be made by the City during implementation, in consultation with the selected vendor, to ensure compliance with City policies, regulatory requirements, and integration needs.

83. Q. What are the expected performance or uptime requirements for the primary LLM, and how would the City define "unavailable" for the primary LLM, triggering the need for a backup?

A. The City expects the primary LLM to meet enterprise-grade performance and availability standards. At a minimum, vendors should design solutions that provide:

- **Uptime Requirement:** 99.9% availability on a monthly basis.
- **Response Time:** Sub-second latency for common queries and under 2–3 seconds for complex requests.
- **Scalability:** Ability to handle peak usage periods without degradation of service.

Definition of 'Unavailable':

The City defines the primary LLM as "unavailable" if any of the following conditions occur:

- **Complete inability to process requests (hard downtime).**
- **Sustained degradation where response times exceed 10 seconds for more than 5 consecutive minutes.**
- **Error rates (failed or incomplete responses) exceed 5% of transactions within a 15-minute window.**

Backup/Failover Expectations:

Vendors should provide a secondary LLM or backup mechanism that can be automatically invoked in the event of unavailability, ensuring continuity of service with minimal disruption.”

84. Q. Regarding Large Language Model (LLM) Choice and Operation, the ITN asks vendors to specify the LLM and if the City can choose it, as well as a backup option. If the City can choose the LLM, what are the primary criteria that would influence this decision (e.g., cost, specific performance metrics, data residency, ethical considerations, open-source preference)? Additionally,

A. If the City is given the option to select the Large Language Model (LLM), the decision will be guided by a set of criteria that balance security, compliance, cost-effectiveness, and functionality. Primary factors include:

- **Cost & Licensing Model:** Total cost of ownership, including licensing, scaling, and support.
- **Performance Metrics:** Accuracy, response time, scalability, and adaptability to municipal use cases.
- **Data Residency & Security:** Preference for U.S.-based hosting to align with CJIS, HIPAA, PCI, and state-level compliance requirements.
- **Ethical & Responsible AI Considerations:** Transparency, bias mitigation, explainability, and adherence to responsible AI principles.
- **Integration Capabilities:** Ability to connect with City systems (e.g., permitting, CRM, ERP, SharePoint).
- **Flexibility & Future-Proofing:** Support for multiple models or open-source options to avoid vendor lock-in and adapt as technology evolves.

85. Q. Will the City provide Microsoft Power BI licenses, or should proposers include licensing in their pricing?

A. Proposers should include pricing in their proposals.

86. Q. Does the City expect 24/7 chatbot uptime and vendor-provided Tier 1/2 support, or will internal IT handle some support tiers?

A. Yes, the City expects the chatbot solution to provide 24/7 uptime to ensure residents and staff have continuous access. Vendors should include monitoring, incident response, and Tier 1/Tier 2 support as part of their offering, particularly for system availability, technical troubleshooting, and escalations.

The City’s internal IT team will serve as Tier 3 support for integration issues, security, and system administration. Vendors should clearly define support roles, escalation paths, and SLAs to ensure seamless coordination between vendor support and City IT.

87. Q. What are the City's projected usage volumes (daily queries, peak load, number of concurrent users)?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

88. Q. Regarding CRM Integration, the ITN states the City does not currently have a CRM system but is open to either integrating with a third-party CRM or considering an integrated solution from the vendor. What is the City's current strategic direction or preference regarding a CRM solution? Are there any specific CRM systems or types being considered for future implementation, or is the City actively seeking a vendor-provided integrated CRM as part of this ITN? Clarifying this will significantly impact the scope and cost of CRM-related features in our proposal.

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

89. Q. If the City does not currently use a CRM, should proposers include costs for CRM implementation, or only ensure compatibility with future CRM adoption?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

90. Q. Regarding Cost Proposal (Pricing Methodology), the cost proposal requires a detailed breakdown, including pricing methodology (per seat, population-based, etc.). Does the City have a preferred pricing model (e.g., subscription per user, per conversation, per API call, population-based for Doral citizens, or a hybrid model)? What is the estimated population of Doral citizens the City anticipates interacting with the chatbot annually, or what is the expected annual volume of chatbot interactions?

A. The City does not mandate a single pricing model but is open to evaluating different approaches, including subscription per user, per conversation, per API call, population-based (for Doral residents), or a hybrid model. Vendors should clearly define their pricing methodology and demonstrate how it scales with usage to ensure transparency and cost predictability.

At this time, the City's estimated population is approximately 75,000 residents, though chatbot interactions may also include businesses, visitors, and other stakeholders. The City anticipates a high volume of annual chatbot interactions as adoption grows, and vendors are encouraged to propose scalable pricing models that account for growth in both resident engagement and departmental use cases.

91. Q. Regarding Customizable Workflows and Cost Impact: To accurately align our cost proposal with the City's needs for "Customizable Workflows" and the "easy-to-use interface for City staff to update content, workflows", could the City clarify the expected level of post-implementation flexibility? Specifically, will the City require dynamic workflows that are fully configurable by internal staff for ongoing adjustments, which typically leads to significantly higher costs, or would a solution based on more predefined workflow templates that may necessitate vendor support for substantial modifications also meet the City's requirements?

A. The City values post-implementation flexibility but also recognizes the cost implications of fully dynamic workflow configuration. The City's expectation is a balanced approach:

- **Baseline Requirement:** An easy-to-use interface that allows City staff to make routine adjustments to workflows (e.g., updating steps, routing, notifications, or approval chains) without vendor intervention.
- **Advanced Modifications:** For more substantial re-designs or complex integrations, the City is open to engaging vendor support as needed.

A solution based solely on rigid, predefined templates would not fully meet the City's requirements, but the City does not require unlimited dynamic workflow flexibility that would drive significantly higher costs. Instead, the City seeks a practical, cost-effective model that empowers staff to manage day-to-day workflow updates while retaining vendor support for major enhancements.

92. Q. We recognize that the City is seeking references, including the Proposer's Qualification Project Experience form and the Performance Evaluation Survey form. Is the City also seeking case study writeups as a part of the response, as mentioned on page 24?

A. Yes, you may add case study write-ups related to your previous work that would be in-line with this ITN solicitation and its Scope Work

93. Q. As a prospective proposer of this ITN, we are going to bid for any ITN of the City for the first time, do we need to follow any specific qualification criteria to participate in this bid?

A. The qualification criteria will be determined by the Evaluation Committee as to your response to this ITN. Please refer to page 24, Section 4.1, prospective proposers are to submit the outlined sections items on Section 4.1.

94. Q. There is a requirement that "the vendor must show experience chatbot deployments with government or public sector, or equivalent complex integrations.". Is it ok to have such experience outside of United States?

A. Yes, this question has been answered previously on other Addendums issued. Only requirement is the selected vendor is to have a physical office located within the United States.

95. Q. Our pricing model is consumption based on usage, is estimated pricing acceptable to meet the requirements of the RFPs?

A. Yes, estimated pricing is acceptable as long as the methodology is clearly defined and transparent. The City understands that consumption-based pricing models vary with usage, and therefore expects vendors to provide assumptions, rate structures, and sample cost scenarios (e.g., low, medium, and high usage tiers).

96. Q. Chat Sizing:
- a. How many chat messages are expected per day/month?
 - b. How many Lambda's/CRM lookups will be required per month/per chat

A. Chat Message Volume

The City does not yet have precise historical data on chatbot message volume, as this will be a new implementation. However, based on population (~75,000 residents) and anticipated adoption, the City estimates:

- **Daily: 500–1,000 chat messages during initial rollout.**
- **Monthly: 15,000–30,000 chat messages, with growth expected as additional departments and services are added.**

Lambda / CRM Lookups

The expected number of Lambda functions or CRM lookups will vary by use case (e.g., permitting, inspections, service requests). For planning purposes, the City anticipates:

- **Per Chat: 1–3 lookups on average (e.g., status check, scheduling, or record retrieval).**
- **Monthly: 10,000–20,000 lookups across all interactions, with scalability required as adoption grows.**

97. Q. How is the chat bot being used?

A. Planned Use Cases for the Chatbot

1. Resident Services & FAQs

- o Answer common questions (e.g., office hours, contact information, city events).
- o Provide department-specific FAQs (Permitting, Parks & Rec, Public Works, Code Enforcement, etc.).

2. Permitting & Licensing

- o Intake guidance for permits and applications.
- o Inspection scheduling and status updates.
- o Integration with Tyler Technologies permitting system.

3. Service Requests & Notifications

- o Report issues like potholes, streetlight outages, or code violations.
- o Push notifications about closures, emergencies, or city events.

- o Optional SMS/email alerts with opt-in/consent management.

4. Workflows & Transactions

- o Appointment scheduling (e.g., inspections, facility rentals).
- o Utility billing reminders and account lookups.
- o Parks & Recreation program registrations.

5. Internal Efficiency

- o Free up City staff from repetitive calls/emails.
- o Centralized dashboard integration (Power BI) to track metrics and adoption.
- o Expandable knowledge base that City staff can manage overtime.

98. Q. How many workflows or business outcomes is the chatbot being used for?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

99. Q. Could you describe each workflow or business outcome:

- i. Scheduling appointments
 - 1. What are the appointments being scheduled for?
 - 2. SMS Confirmation
 - 3. SMS Cancellation
- ii. Service Requests
 - 1. What type of services are handled by the chatbot?
 - a. Could you describe each service offered.
- iii. FAQ?
 - 1. Could you describe the FAQ
 - a. Addresses, Phone numbers, Appointments, Permits, Service requests etc.
- iv. Doral Police Department?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

100. Q. What data or information is the chatbot requesting, passing, retrieving storing?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

101. Q. How many CRM integrations are required?

- i. For which systems?
 - 1. Salesforce
 - 2. Microsoft Dynamics?
- ii. What data fields are being passed/retrieved/stored?
 - 1. Account Number?
 - 2. Invoice Number?
 - 3. Additional Fields?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

102. Q. Is the chatbot escalating to an Agent?

- i. If yes, which contact center system/manufacture?
- II. Is chat history being passed to the agent?
- 1. Does any PCI or PII information need to be redacted?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

103. Q. Is the chatbot taking payments?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

104. Q. What is the is IVR system/Manufacture?

- i. Could you describe how you envision the chatbot interacting with the IVR?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

105. Q. What information or data is being scraped?

- i. What is the information being used for?
- ii. Where is the information being stored?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

106. Q. Social Channels?

- i. Does the City of Doral have business accounts for Facebook, WhatsApp, Instagram?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

107. Q. SMS

- i. Could you provide an estimated number of messages Inbound per month?
- ii. Could you provide an estimated number of messages Onbound per month?
- 1. How many will be 10DLC?
- 2. How many will be Short Code?
- 3. How many will be Long Code?
- 4. How many will be Toll-Free?

A. At this time, the City does not have precise historical data on SMS traffic, as this capability has not yet been implemented. However, based on anticipated use cases (alerts, reminders, notifications, and resident interactions)

108. Q. Sentiment Analysis

- i. Is there any action take based on sentiment analysis?
- 1. For example proactive customer support
- 2. Automatic escalation?

A. Yes. The City anticipates leveraging sentiment analysis to improve customer service and responsiveness. Actions based on sentiment analysis may include:

1. Proactive Customer Support:

- **If negative sentiment is detected (e.g., frustration, dissatisfaction), the chatbot may prompt the user with additional resources, clarify responses, or offer to connect with a live agent.**

2. Automatic Escalation:

- **Conversations flagged with persistent negative sentiment or keywords related to urgent issues may be automatically escalated to Tier 1 support staff or routed to the appropriate department for follow-up.**

109. Q. PowerBI

i. How many customer reports are required?

A. At this time, the City does not have precise historical data.

110. Q. What are your expected digital (web, SMS, social media) interaction volumes for the proposed AI-powered chatbot solution?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

111. Q. What are the expected voice call volumes for the proposed AI-powered chatbot solution?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

112. Q. What are your top contact reasons and what percentage of overall volume are they?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

113. Q. Does the City have an anticipated budget range or funding ceiling for this chatbot project?

A. Presently, the City does not have an anticipated budget as to the reason why an ITN has been issued.

113. Q. Are there specific City departments or use cases (e.g., permitting, utilities, police, HR) that are considered “must-have” in the initial rollout versus optional in later phases?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

114. Q. Does the City expect the chatbot to function as a general FAQ assistant only, or also as a transactional assistant (e.g., appointment scheduling, service request submission)?

- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**
115. Q. The RFP mentions the possibility of CRM integration or adopting a vendor-provided CRM. Which direction is the City leaning, and are there preferred CRM platforms under consideration?
- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**
116. Q. How does the City define “success” for this chatbot project, citizen adoption rate, reduced call volumes, faster response times, or other KPIs?
- A. The City defines success for the chatbot project as a combination of measurable outcomes that demonstrate value to both residents and staff.**
117. Q. The RFP requires use of a Large Language Model (LLM) (GPT, BERT, etc.). Does the City prefer open-source vs. commercial LLMs?
- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**
118. Q. Is there a requirement for on-premise vs. cloud deployment of the LLM?
- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**
119. Q. What are the City’s expectations around fallback/backup LLMs
- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**
120. Q. Are there any non-functional requirements around the chatbot’s performance?
- A. Performance & Responsiveness**
- **P95 response time: ≤ 2 seconds for common queries; ≤ 3–5 seconds for complex, multi-system lookups.**
 - **Cold start (first interaction after idle): ≤ 3 seconds.**
 - **Streaming responses: Begin within 1 second where supported.**

Throughput & Concurrency

- **Sustain 200 concurrent sessions baseline; elastic scale to 1,000+ during events without degradation.**
- **Rate limiting/back-pressure with graceful messaging when limits are reached.**

Availability & Reliability

- **Uptime: 99.9% monthly for the chatbot service; transparent maintenance windows.**
- **Error budget & SLOs: Vendor to publish SLI dashboards (latency, error rate, availability).**

Scalability

- Horizontal scaling for spikes (e.g., storms, elections, major events).
- Auto-scaling policies documented and tested under load.

Accuracy & Quality

- Answer accuracy target: $\geq 85\%$ at launch, trending to $\geq 90\%$ within 6–12 months.
- Deflection rate (resolved without human): initial $\geq 50\%$, with quarterly improvement plans.

Resilience & DR

- Failover: Automatic to backup LLM/provider on primary degradation.
- RTO: ≤ 1 hour; RPO: ≤ 15 minutes for configuration/knowledge base.
- Regional redundancy for hosting where feasible.

Security & Privacy (performance-adjacent)

- MFA for admin access; TLS 1.2+; OWASP controls for APIs.
- No PII persistence beyond defined retention; data minimization for prompts/logs.
- Audit logging of admin/content changes with immutable retention per policy.

Observability

- Centralized logs, metrics, traces; export to City SIEM/monitoring.
- Real-time health endpoints; monthly SLA reports; alerting with severity tie.

121. Q. The scope mentions daily website scraping for content updates. Will City provide structured APIs, or must the vendor rely solely on scraping unstructured website content?

A. The City prefers vendors to consume structured data through APIs wherever possible, as this ensures accuracy, efficiency, and long-term maintainability. The City can provide or enable structured APIs for certain systems (e.g., permitting, SharePoint, Power BI, selected departmental applications) and will work with the selected vendor to define the most efficient data access methods.

122. Q. Are there restrictions on scraping frequency/load?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

123. Q. What are the expectations on scraping timing? The RFP mentions daily scraping but if the site is updated after the daily trigger, is it valid for the information to be available to the bot the next day?

- A. The City's baseline expectation is that public website content will be scraped and refreshed once daily, ensuring that updates are reflected in the chatbot by the next business day.**

If content is updated after the daily scraping cycle, it is acceptable for the chatbot to surface that information starting with the next scheduled refresh (typically the following day)

124. Q. The City requires document parsing (PDFs, DOCX, SharePoint). Will the City provide direct access to these repositories, or must parsing be via citizen-uploaded documents?

- A. The City will provide direct, secured access to its repositories for document parsing, rather than relying on citizen-uploaded documents.**

125. Q. What are the potential data sources for the chatbot to ingest besides the city website and documents listed above? For each additional integration please clarify the integration mechanism available (REST, SOAP, Database Query, etc...).

- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**

126. Q. For Power BI analytics integration: Will the City provide an existing Power BI environment/tenant, or must the vendor provision this?

- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum**

127. Q. Are there specific KPIs and dashboards already defined, or should the vendor propose them?

- A. Vendor to propose.**

128. Q. For IVR and social media integration: Which IVR platform does the City currently use (Avaya, Cisco, etc.)? Which social channels are considered mandatory vs. optional (e.g., LinkedIn, WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook)?

- A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**

129. Q. The RFP references SMS capabilities: Does the City already have an SMS provider (e.g., Twilio, Five9, GONG), or should the vendor propose one? Are two-way SMS interactions required, or only outbound alerts?

- A. No and only outbound alerts.**

130. Q. The chatbot mentions the need to capture user information for follow-ups but doesn't mention login/SSO. Is there an existing system for user Authentication to allow the bot to provide custom responses to users or should the chatbot function without any authentication?

- A. Chatbot function without any authentication.**

131. Q. What are the expectations of admin and staff access to the chatbot system?

- A. The City expects a tiered and role-based access model for administration and staff use of the chatbot system.**

132. Q. What are the expected usage volumes for the chatbot? Rough projections will be helpful here.
- A. **As this will be the City's first enterprise chatbot deployment, exact usage volumes are not yet available.**
133. Q. Is there an expectation of escalation to Human Support if the chatbot cannot fully support the user? If yes, when in the phased deployment should that be ready?
- A. **Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**
134. Q. A Sample Agreement has been provided for review. Can modifications to this agreement be proposed at the time of proposal submission, or will the awarded proposer be given an opportunity to negotiate the agreement upon award?
- A. **No. The city is open to discussion as to the terms and conditions during the negotiation phase of the ITN procurement process.**
135. Q. Will the City reimburse for sunk costs or committed resources if termination happens early in implementation?
- A. **No. The City does not anticipate reimbursing vendors for sunk costs or committed resources in the event of early termination. Vendors are expected to structure their pricing to account for this risk.**
- The City may, however, agree to compensate for services or deliverables that have been completed, accepted, and documented up to the effective termination date, in accordance with contract terms.**
- All proposed contracts must include clear language around termination for convenience and termination for cause, and vendors should outline any minimum commitments or non-recoverable costs in their pricing proposals for the City's review.**
136. Q. The contract structure is 3 years with 2 optional 1-year renewals. What are the City's expectations around pricing stability during renewals (fixed, capped increases, renegotiation)?
- A. **The City of open to negotiation. For the initial 3 years, the city's preference is an all-inclusive set price, and years 4 and 5 the City is open to discussion as to any changes to pricing.**
137. Q. Do you participate in cooperative purchasing programs (OMNIA, NASPO, Carahsoft)?
- A. **Yes, the City does.**
138. Q. Support & maintenance expectations are not detailed. Does the City require 24/7 support or business hours only? What are the expected response and resolution SLAs for chatbot outages or incidents?
- A. **Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.**

139. Q. Does the city require use of FedRAMP-authorized services or other government certifications?
- A. **Yes. The City requires that any cloud-hosted components of the solution meet federal, state, and local compliance standards. Vendors leveraging FedRAMP-authorized services for hosting and data processing, particularly where sensitive or regulated information is involved.**
140. Q. The ITN notes that no performance or payment bonds are required. Since AI-powered chatbots are adaptive learning systems, there is often an initial stabilization period where accuracy and performance improve over time. Could the City clarify whether the decision to not require bonding reflects an understanding of this iterative improvement process, and if the City would consider defining phased performance expectations or acceptance criteria during the early stages of deployment?
- A. **The City is open to discussing phased performance expectations or acceptance criteria during the early stages of deployment during the negotiation phase of this ITN.**
141. Q. Will the City of Doral accept a joint proposal between two entities partnering on a solution, or would we be required to have one party submit the proposal with the other being a subcontractor to the prime?
- A. **The city's preference would be to negotiate an agreement with a Prime firm that is responsible for the complete application, implementation, training and support services. The Prime firm may subcontract portions of the work that is required.**
142. Q. Is the City expecting a feature-by-feature rollout, or a phased approach starting with high-demand departments such as Building and Parks?
- A. **The City anticipates a phased rollout rather than a feature-by-feature deployment. The initial phase will prioritize high-demand departments and services that generate the greatest resident engagement and internal workload**
143. Q. Which services or departments are considered priority use cases for the chatbot at launch (e.g., Building, Parks, HR)?
- A. **The City anticipates a phased rollout rather than a feature-by-feature deployment. The initial phase will prioritize high-demand departments and services that generate the greatest resident engagement and internal workload**
144. Q. Does the City already have a service catalog or documented workflows that map out current citizen interactions?
- A. **Response to this question will be provided during the negotiation Phase of this ITN procurement process.**

145. Q. Are there any services explicitly out of scope for the chatbot (e.g., emergency services, police dispatch)?
- A. **No.**
146. Q. As the current scope does not explicitly mention Tyler ERP, should we consider ERP integration in our solution or exclude it?
- A. **Yes, ERP Integration.**
147. Q. Will the City provide sandbox/test environments for these systems during development?
- A. **Yes. The City will provide sandbox or test environments for key systems during development and integration. These environments will allow vendors to test workflows, APIs, and integrations without impacting production systems.**
148. Q. Does the City currently have a CRM or ticketing system in use, or should we propose one?
- A. **No**
149. Q. Is integration with NeoGov, MailChimp, Vermont Software Solutions, and Tyler ERP expected as part of the solution?
- A. **Not at this point, but can be discussed during the negotiation phase of this ITN.**
150. Q. Does the City maintain a central document repository (e.g., SharePoint, OneDrive), or are documents distributed across departmental sites?
- A. **Documents are distributed across departmental sites.**
151. Q. Can the City provide examples of priority forms that must be conversationally supported at launch (e.g., Adopt a Garden, permit forms)?
- A. **Response to this question will be provided during the negotiation Phase of this ITN procurement process.**
152. Q. Are there data sensitivity levels defined (e.g., public, restricted, confidential) that must be applied to chatbot content?
- A. **Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum**
153. Q. What are the City's expectations for staff training — specifically the number of staff and whether it should be role-based (IT, Communications, Departments)?
- A. **The City expects vendors to provide comprehensive training to ensure successful adoption and long-term sustainability of the chatbot solution. Training should be role-based and tailored to the responsibilities of each group. Anticipated participants include:**

- **IT Department (Core Admin Team): ~2–4 staff members. Training should cover system administration, integrations, security, monitoring, and advanced troubleshooting.**
- **Communications & Public Affairs: ~2–3 staff members. Training should focus on managing content, announcements, FAQs, and resident-facing messaging.**
- **Departmental Representatives / Goal Leaders: ~10–15 staff members across Building, Public Works, Parks & Recreation, Code Enforcement, Finance, and other high-usage departments. Training should address workflow updates, content contribution, and use-case management.**
- **Executive/Leadership Overview: 1–2 leadership staff. A high-level session focused on dashboards, metrics, and decision-support features.**

154. Q. What are the City’s expectations for support SLAs (response time, resolution time, uptime guarantees)?

A. Answer to this question has been provided in previous issued Addendum.

155. Q. Will the City provide a primary point of contact who will be actively available throughout the duration of the project?

A. Yes.

156. Q. Can you clarify what format(s) the website content is currently stored in (e.g., text, PDF, images, video)?

A. All of that are mentioned.

157. Q. Is there a defined structure or schema for the raw data that can be shared with vendors?

A. Response to this question will be provided during the negotiation Phase of this ITN procurement process.

158. Q. Does the City use a content management system (CMS) such as WordPress, or another platform, to manage and store website content?

A. CMS – Granicus.

159. Q. How is website data currently stored in the backend (e.g., database, file storage, hybrid)?

A. Hybrid.

160. Q. Beyond standard web pages, are there other content types we should anticipate (e.g., interactive forms, GIS layers, video archives)?

A. Yes. Beyond standard web pages, the City anticipates that the chatbot will need to access and interpret a variety of content types, including:

- **Interactive Forms:** Online applications, permit submission forms, and service request forms.
- **GIS Layers / Maps:** Interactive maps for zoning, utilities, transportation routes, and service boundaries.
- **Video & Media Archives:** Recorded City Council meetings, public service videos, and training content.
- **Event Calendars & Schedules:** Parks programs, public meetings, and community events.

161. Q. If we are proposing exceptions to the RFP, how would City of Doral like us to handle the solicitation response form?

A. As per Section 2.10, proposer that has any exception to the ITN may provide those exceptions, if any, in a list and provide the section no. in the ITN with an explanation to the exception and reasons thereof. Please note, any exceptions to the material provisions of this Solicitation, as determined by the City in its sole discretion, may cause the proposal to be considered non-responsive.

162. Q. Historically, our company's board does not pass a resolution for each RFP response. How would you like bidders to provide a notarized certificate of authority if a bidder does not have a Board Resolution for each RFP?

A. If your company follows the business process you have explained in your question, have your company President or other Executive authorized to sign for your company provide an attestation that he/she is authorized to sign and bind your company to an agreement with the City of Doral. This attestation will need to be notarized and submitted with the ITN proposal response. This attestation may be submitted and in lieu of this Certificate of Authority form.

163. Q. Can Canadian companies submit proposals for this ITN, or is U.S. business registration required?

A. A Canadian Company can team up as a Prime/Subcontractor with a company that has US presence and provide an ITN response to this solicitation.

164. Q. E-Verify Compliance: The ITN requires use of the federal E-Verify system. How can a Canadian company comply with this requirement? Would establishing a U.S. subsidiary or partnering with a U.S. entity be acceptable solutions?

A. Yes, by partnering with a US you would be teaming up with a US based company, which is one step. That US based company must enter their information in the E-Verify system prior to providing a response to make sure it meets our E-Verify Requirement.

165. Q. Business Presence: Are there specific requirements for physical presence or business operations in the United States or Florida?

- A. Yes, the company providing the services, either prime or subcontracting firm must have a physical business office in the United States, not necessarily in Florida.**
166. Q. Insurance Requirements: Can Canadian companies meet the Florida-qualified insurance carrier requirements, or would this necessitate U.S. operations?
- A. Not fully understand the question. Certificate of insurance should have all the required thresholds for coverage as outlined in the ITN. It is important to note that the City of Doral MUST be added as additional insured.**
167. Q. Partnership/Subcontracting: Would the City accept proposals where a Canadian company partners with or subcontracts through a qualified U.S. entity?
- A. Yes. You may submit a proposal by partnering or subcontracting, but note that this is a competitive selection process, based on which an Evaluation Committee will subjectively score the proposers. Although the proposal may be deemed responsive, the committee still has latitude as to the scoring methodology utilized this ITN.**

This finalizes all responses to all questions submitted by prospective proposers; no further issued addendum is anticipated.

If you should have any questions regarding this addendum, please do not hesitate to contact roman.martinez@cityofdoral.com.

Sincerely,

Roman Martinez, MBA, CPPO, CPPB
Procurement and Asset Management Director